Remote Desktop Services (RDS) Lab Report

Lab Environment

Server	Server01.lab.com (Domain Controller, domain lab.com), IPs 10.10.10.1 and 192.168.50.100
Client	client01 (Windows 10, joined to lab.com) running in VirtualBox
Role installed	Remote Desktop Services (Connection Broker, Session Host, Web Access)
Collection	StudentApps (Calculator and Notepad published as RemoteApp)
Test account	testuser (lab\testuser)

Task 1: Open Server Manager on your Windows Server VM and use the Add Roles and Features wizard to install the Remote Desktop Services (RDS) role.

I opened Server Manager and ran Add Roles and Features on Server01.lab.com, selecting the Remote Desktop Services role services. The installation completed and the wizard reported that a restart was pending on Server01.lab.com, so I restarted the server to finish the install.

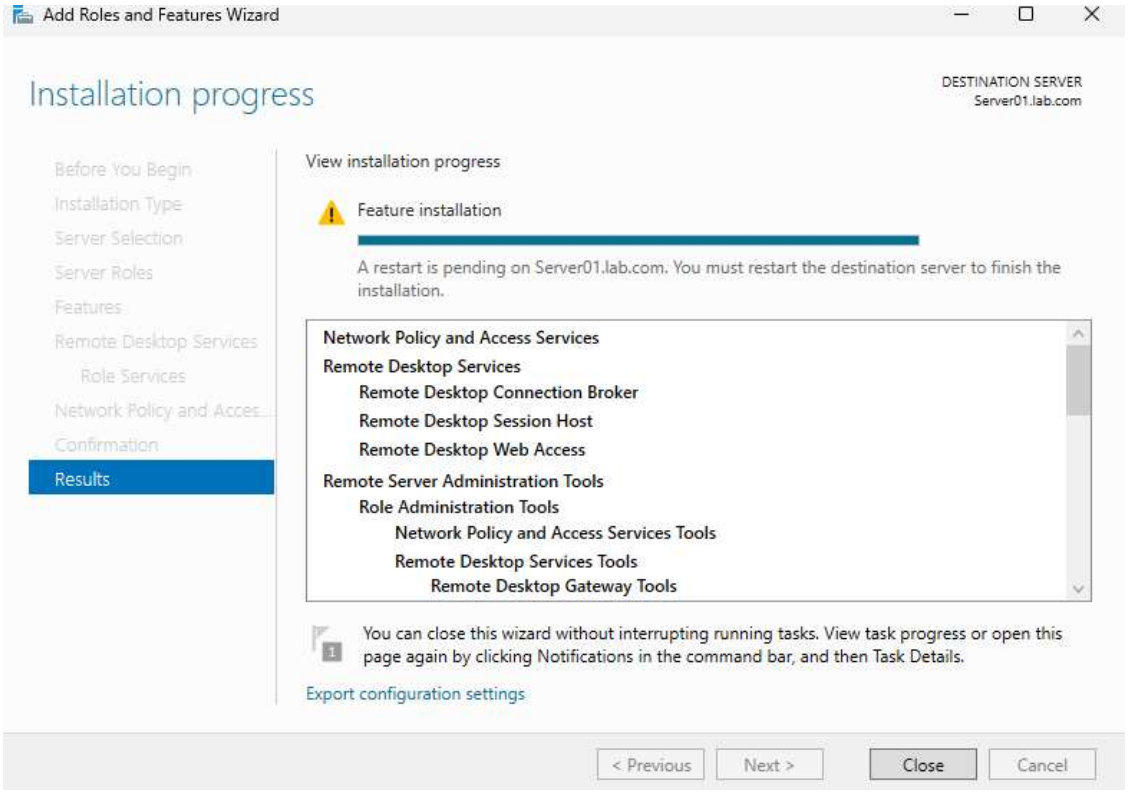


Figure 1: Role installation finished, restart pending on Server01.lab.com

After the restart, Server Manager still said that a Remote Desktop Services deployment did not exist in the server pool. Installing the individual role services does not link them into one working deployment, so I ran the Add Roles and Features wizard again and chose Remote Desktop Services installation.

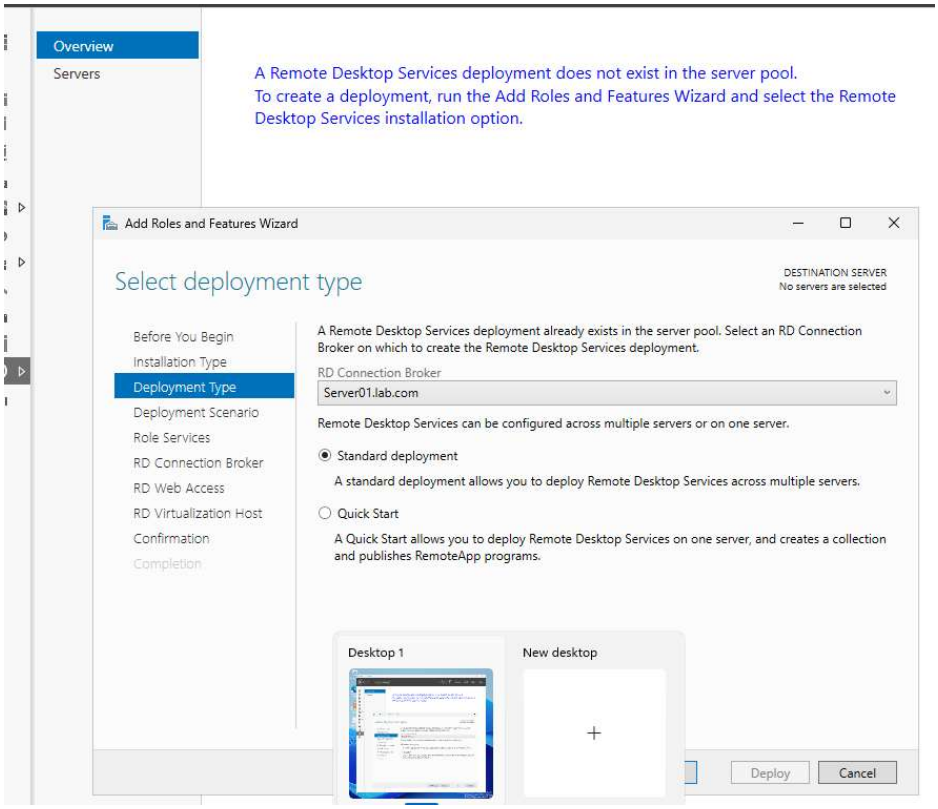


Figure 2: Overview reporting no RDS deployment, with the deployment wizard open

Wizard choices:

- Deployment type: Standard deployment, with Server01.lab.com as the RD Connection Broker
- Deployment scenario: Session-based desktop deployment
- RD Connection Broker, RD Web Access and RD Session Host: all set to Server01.lab.com
- Restart the destination server automatically if required: ticked, then Deploy

After the automatic restart, the Overview page showed the full deployment diagram. The server list shows SERVER01.LAB.COM holding the RD Connection Broker, RD Session Host and RD Web Access roles, and a Collections item appeared in the left menu.

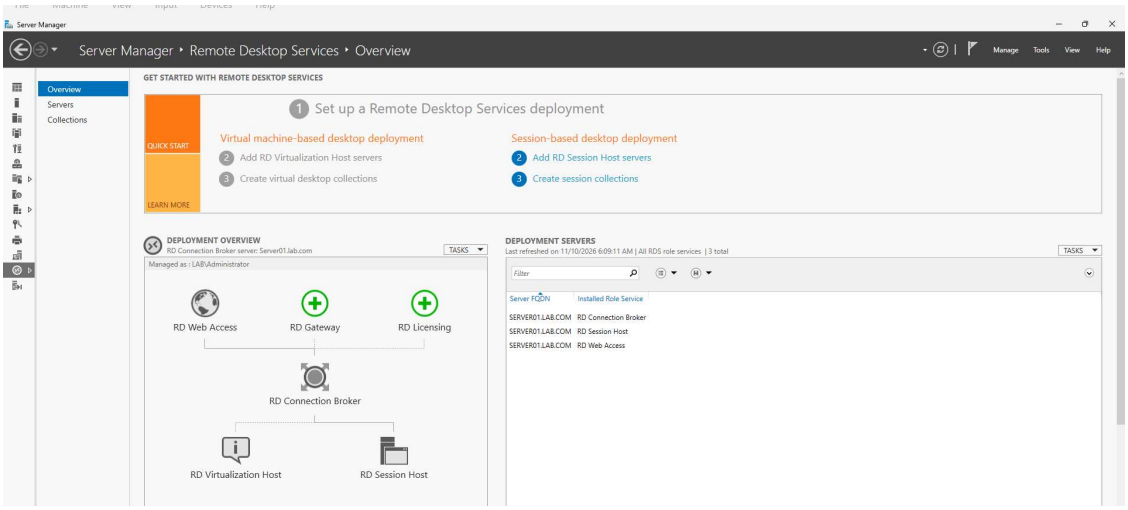


Figure 3: RDS deployment overview with all three roles on SERVER01.LAB.COM

RD Gateway and RD Licensing appear with a green plus icon. This means they are not installed, and they are not needed for this lab. The Virtualization Host is greyed out because this is a session-based deployment, not VDI.

Task 2: Configure a Remote Desktop Session Collection named 'StudentApps' and publish Notepad and Calculator as RemoteApps for users.

From Remote Desktop Services > Collections, I used Tasks > Create Session Collection with these settings:

- Collection name: StudentApps
- RD Session Host: SERVER01 (moved to the selected list)
- User group: LAB\Domain Users (default)
- User profile disks: disabled, because there is no file share for them

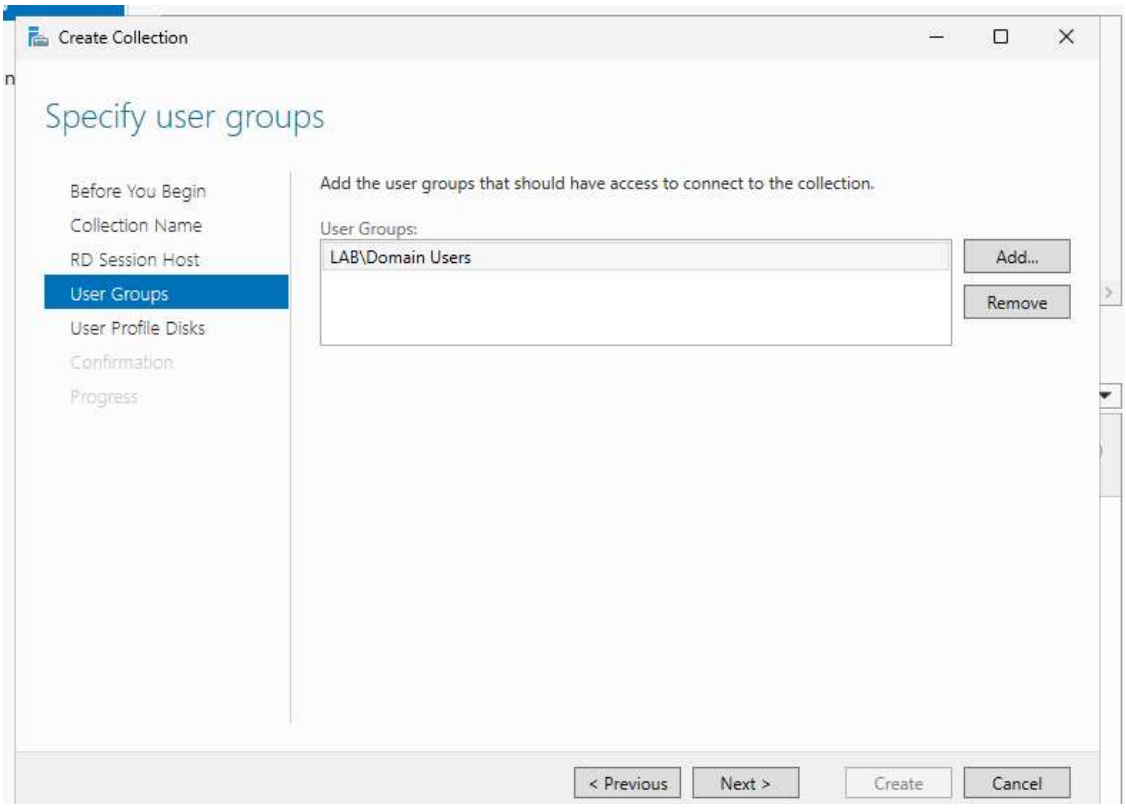


Figure 4: Specify user groups page, LAB\Domain Users allowed

The wizard finished with both Create Collection and Add servers showing Succeeded.

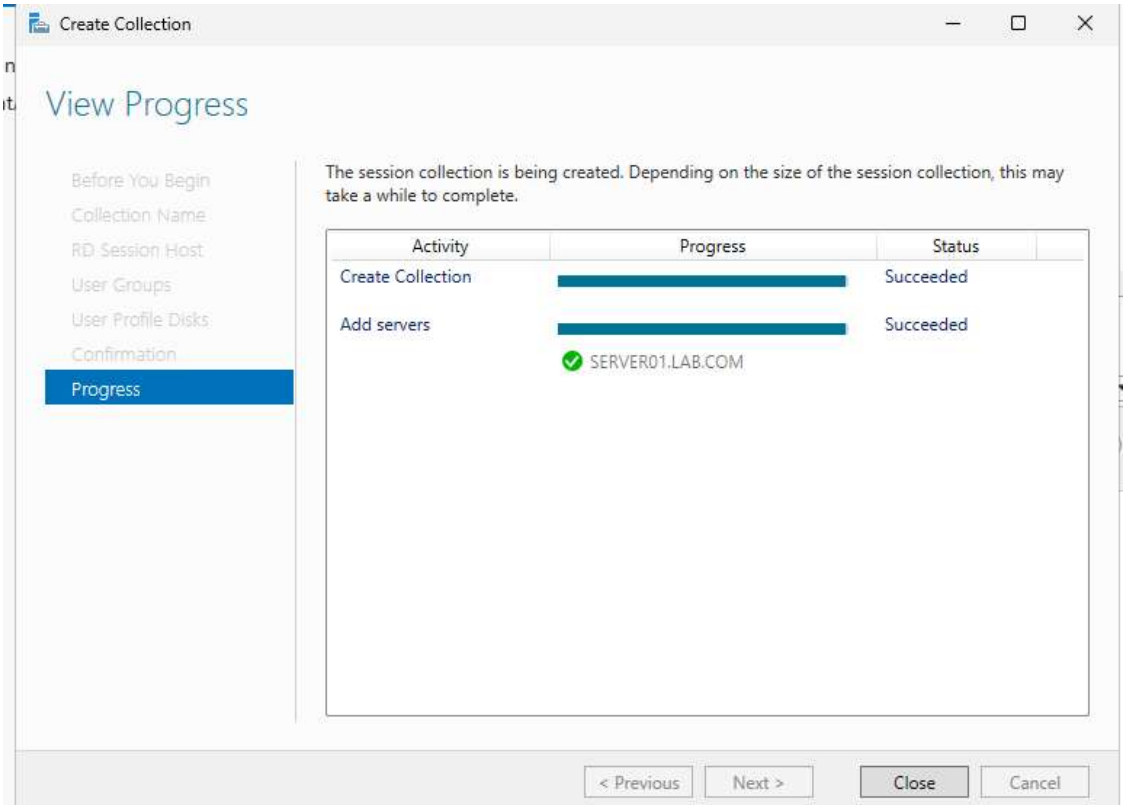


Figure 5: Session collection created successfully

Next, inside the StudentApps collection, I used RemoteApp Programs > Tasks > Publish RemoteApp Programs and selected Calculator and Notepad.

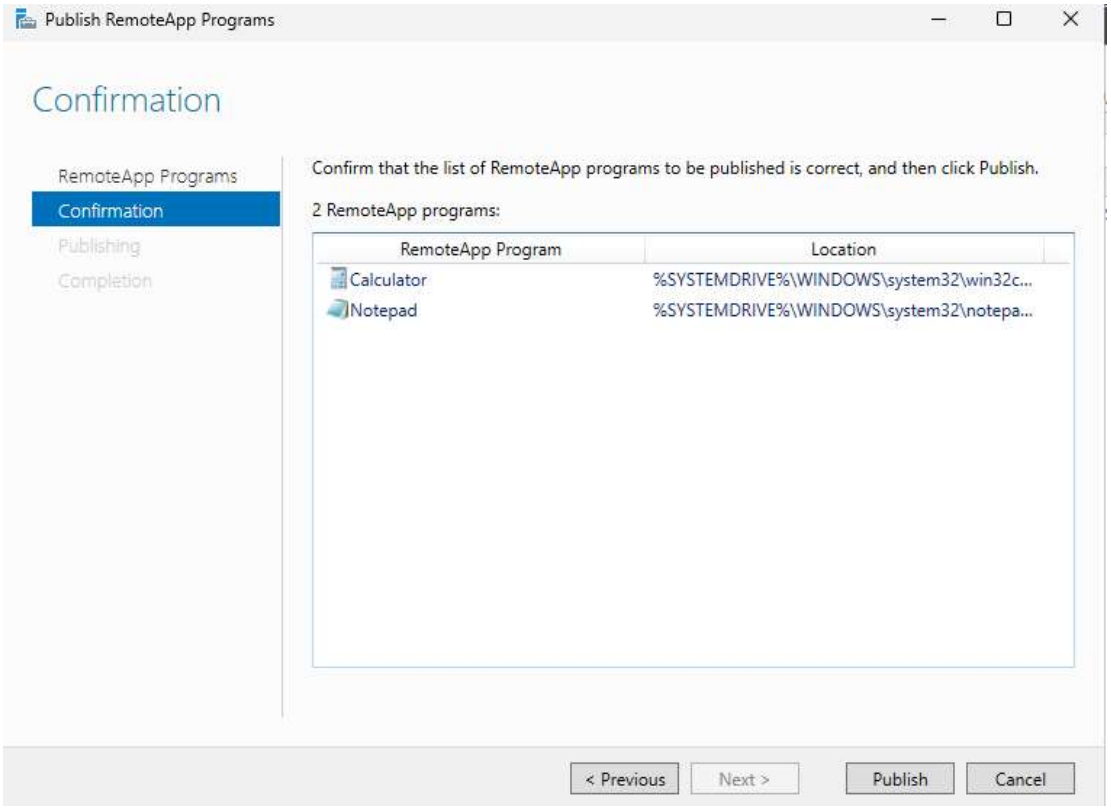


Figure 6: Confirmation page listing Calculator and Notepad

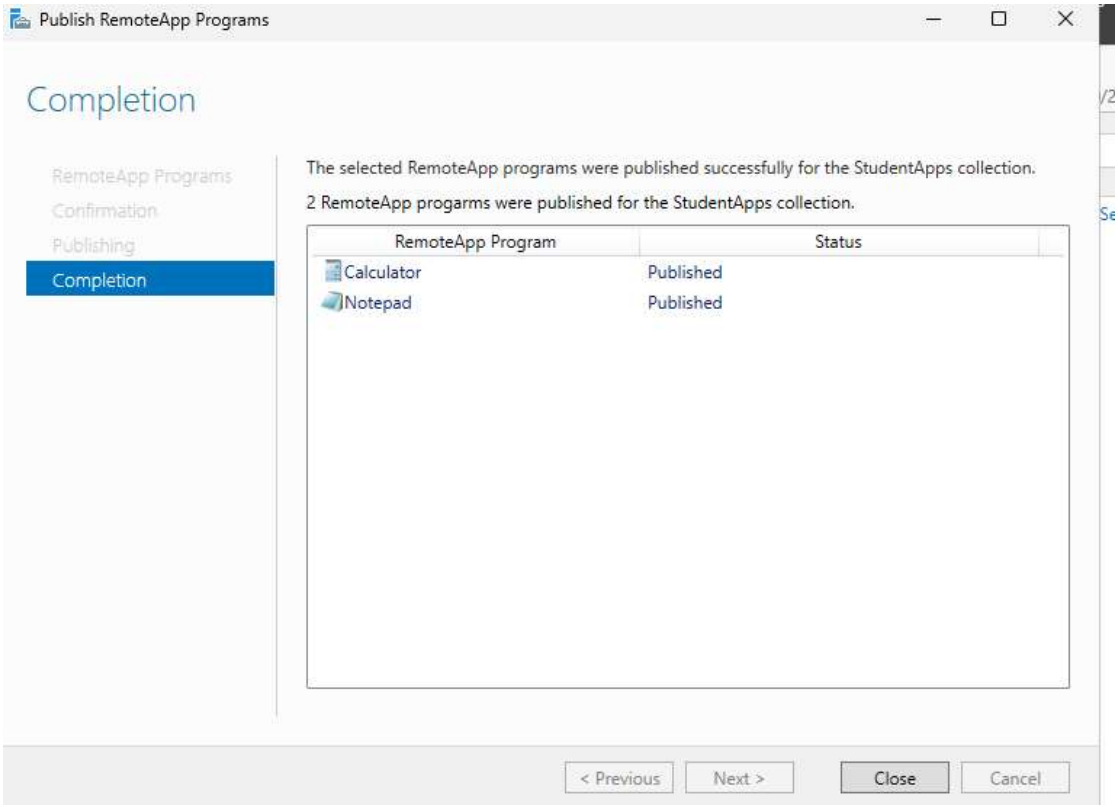


Figure 7: Both programs published for the StudentApps collection

Task 3: Create a new local user account called 'testuser', add it to the Remote Desktop Users group, and verify that this user can successfully connect via Remote Desktop from another device on your network.

Because Server01 is a Domain Controller, there are no local accounts on it, so I created testuser as a domain account in Active Directory Users and Computers (in the RDS OU of lab.com, user logon name testuser). I then added it to the Remote Desktop Users group in the Builtin container.

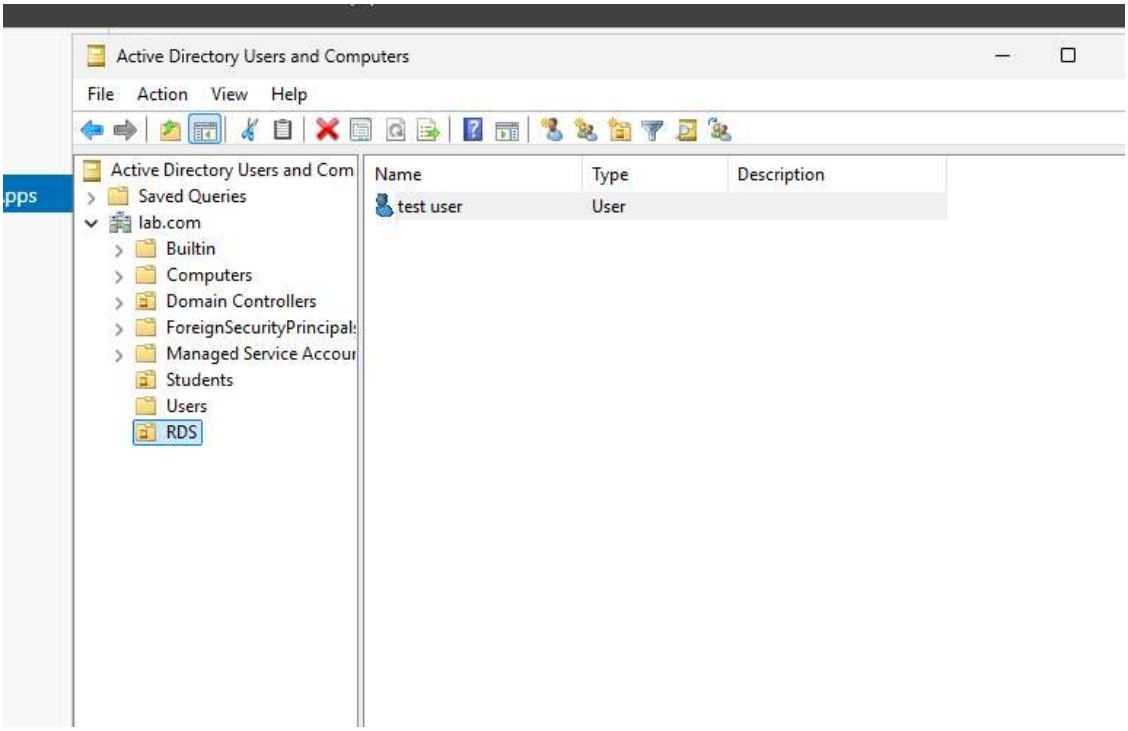


Figure 8: User account created in the RDS OU in Active Directory

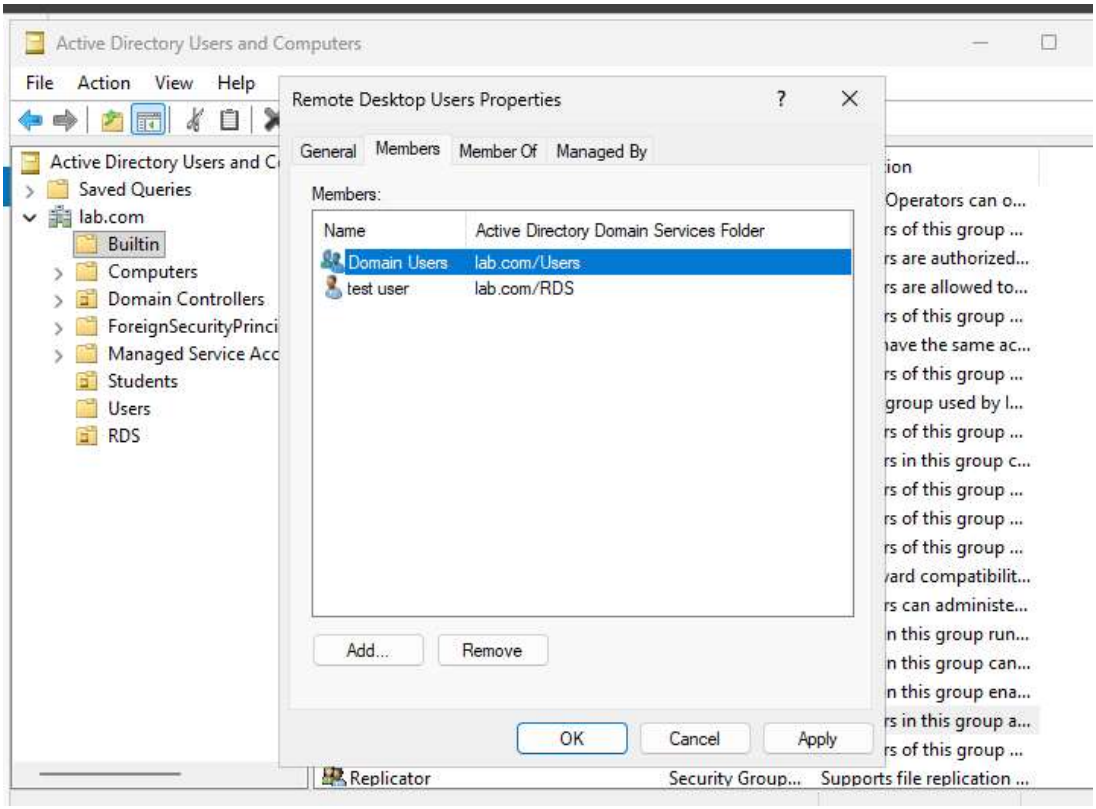


Figure 9: Remote Desktop Users group with test user as a member

To test from another device, I signed in to client01 (Windows 10) and opened Remote Desktop Connection with the following command:

```
mstsc
(computer: 10.10.10.1, user: lab\testuser)
```

The connection succeeded. Running whoami inside the Command Prompt in the remote session returned lab\testuser, which confirms the session belongs to the test account.

```
C:\Windows\system32> whoami
lab\testuser
```

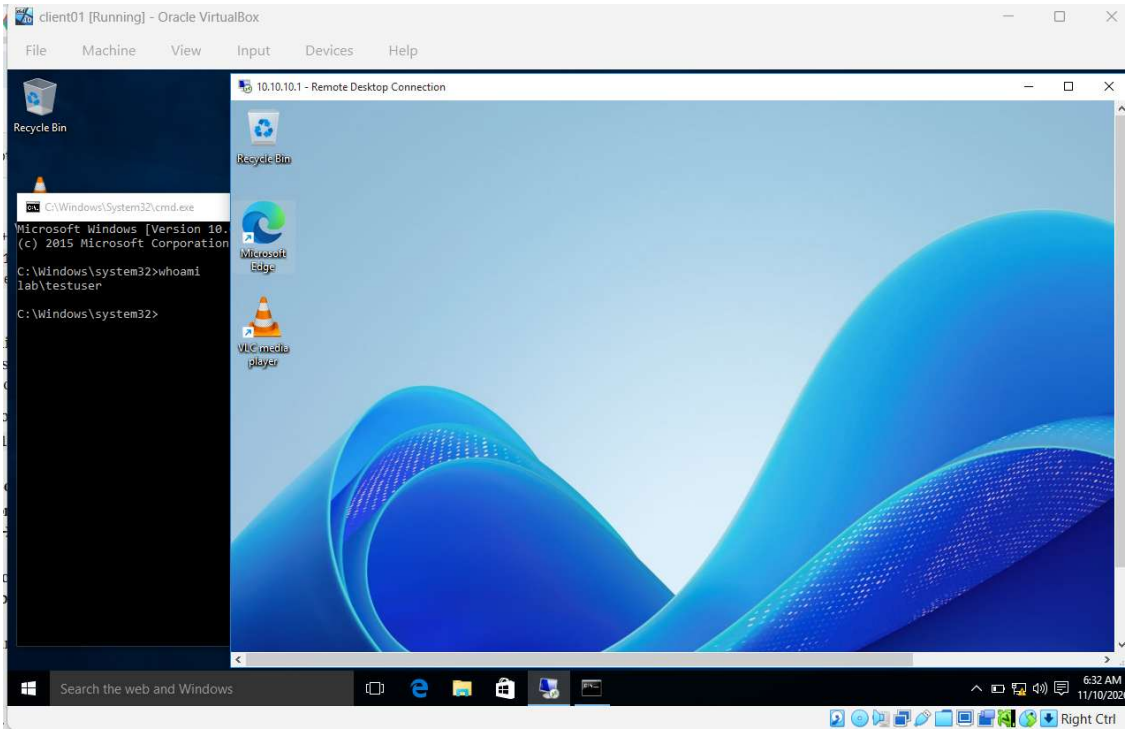


Figure 10: client01 connected to 10.10.10.1 as lab\testuser (whoami output on the left)

Task 4: Simulate a scenario where multiple users are connecting to your RDS server at the same time by launching two Remote Desktop sessions. Observe and note any resource or session limitations you encounter. Hint: Try connecting as both 'Administrator' and 'testuser' and see how the server handles simultaneous logins.

I kept the testuser session from client01 open (to 10.10.10.1) and opened a second Remote Desktop session to the server at 192.168.50.100, signed in as Administrator. In the testuser session, Calculator and Notepad were opened.

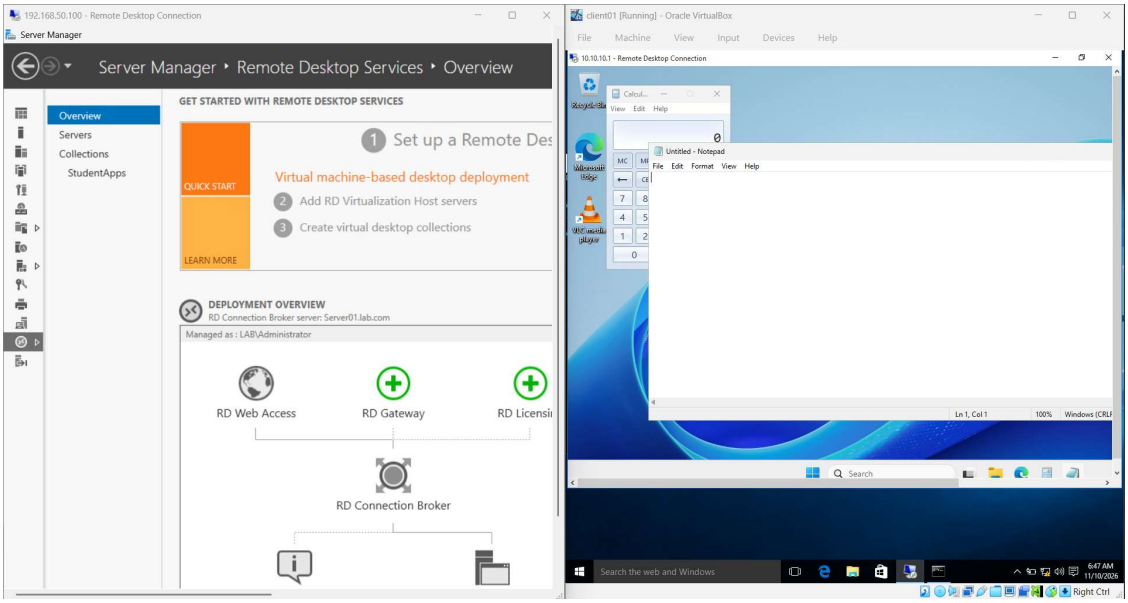


Figure 11: Administrator session (left) and testuser session with Calculator and Notepad (right) at the same time

Running query user on the server from the Administrator session listed both users as Active with separate session IDs. The > symbol marks the session the command was run from.

```
C:\Users\Administrator> query user
 USERNAME       SESSIONNAME    ID  STATE   LOGON TIME
>administrator  rdp-tcp#2       1  Active  11/10/2026 5:45 AM
 testuser       rdp-tcp#0       2  Active  11/10/2026 6:31 AM
```

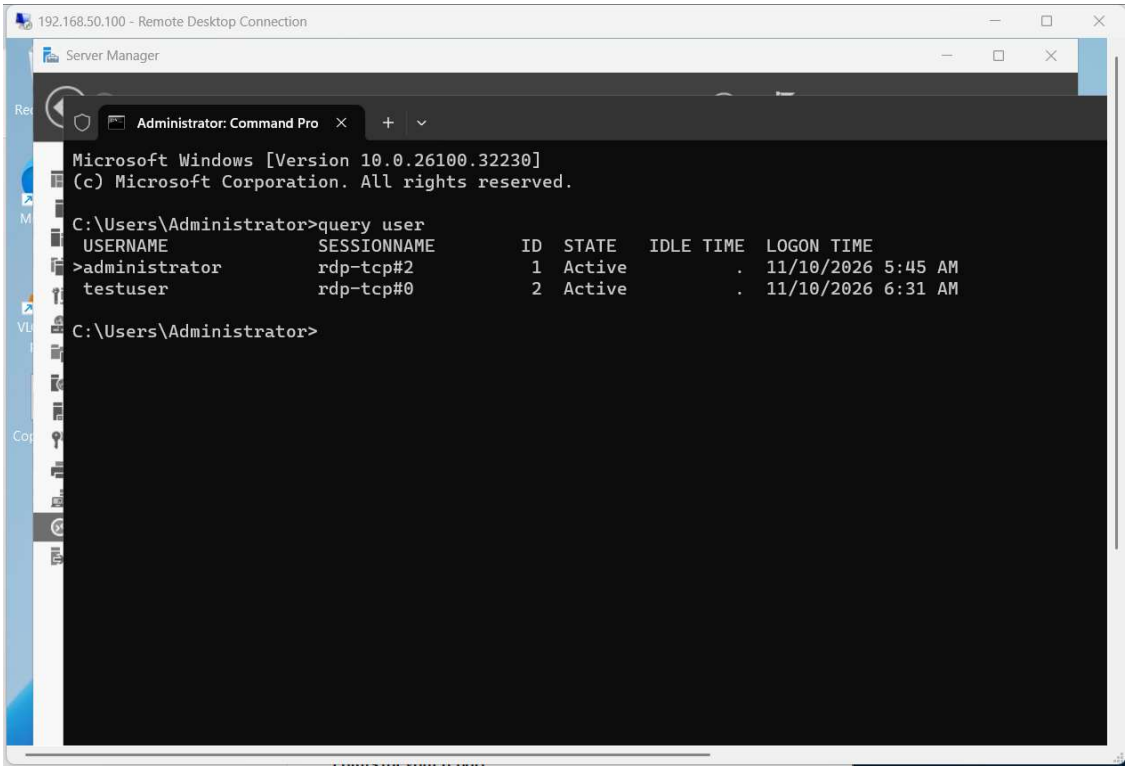


Figure 12: query user run from the Administrator session

Running the same command from inside the testuser session showed the same two sessions, with the > marker now next to testuser.

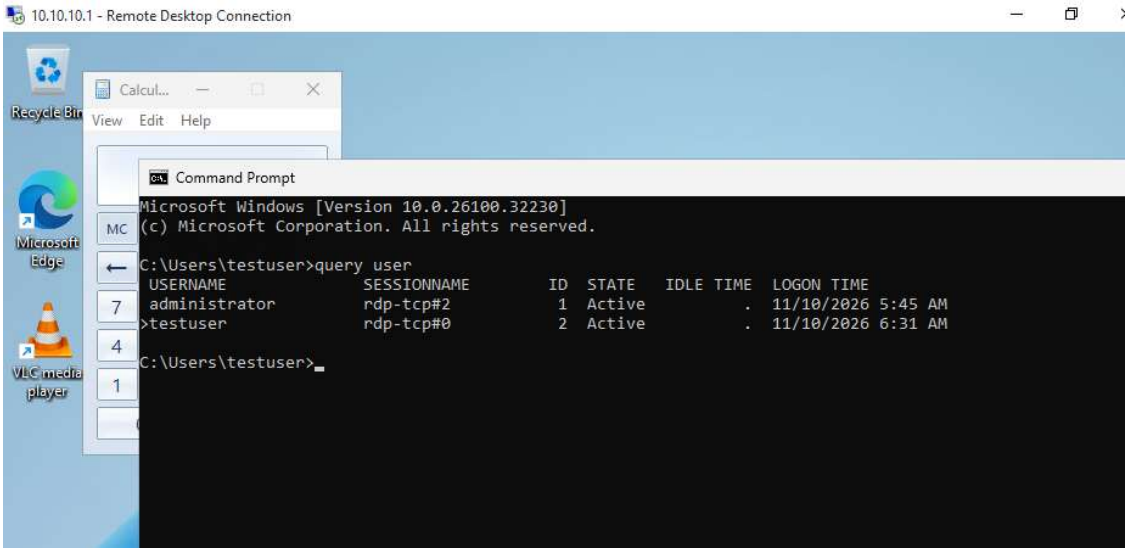


Figure 13: query user run from the testuser session